Instrument for data collection with codes – Erhebungsinstrument mit Codes

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Project title: Effects of news coverage on a victim's character during a crisis

The codes used in the SPSS dataset are provided in blue.

***Introduction**:*

Dear participant,

thank you for your interest to participate in this study on the perception of media coverage about business incidents. You will be shown a news article on a business incident and asked to answer several questions about it. There are no right or wrong answers. Only your personal opinion counts.

Before participating, please note:

- Participation in the study is voluntary. You can cancel the questionnaire at any time.

- Your participation is anonymous. Your answers cannot be traced back to you.

- This also means that your personal data set is not identifiable to us after completion of the survey. If you wish to have information about your data after the study or withdraw your participation, we ask you to note this in the final comment field.

- Your data will be used for scientific purposes only. The research does not follow any commercial interest.

- We treat all your data strictly confidential.

Do you agree to participate in this study? InformedConsent

1 I was informed about my rights in the course of the survey and now wish to proceed.

2 I don´t want to participate.

Stimulus:

Condition: 1 = inappropriate sexual relationship, 2 = alcohol abuse, 3 = control

On the next page you will see the transcript of an article that was published in the Chicago Herald about an incident that happened in the airline industry. Please read the article carefully.

A man wouldn't leave an overbooked flight. So he was dragged off the plane

United Airlines says a man wouldn't give up his spot on an overbooked flight Sunday. The man, a doctor from Kentucky, was one of four passengers selected for removal so that the airline's personnel could be seated on the full flight.

According to witnesses and videos of the incident, the doctor was pulled screaming from his seat by security, knocked against an arm rest and dragged down the aisle and back to the terminal at Chicago's O'Hare International Airport.

Videos of the incident went viral, and the doctor was quickly thrust into the international spotlight.

Inappropriate relationship condition

It became known that the doctor involved in the incident surrendered his medical license in February 2005 after a complaint was filed against him alleging an inappropriate sexual relationship with a patient, according to documents filed with the Kentucky Board of Medical Licensure.

Alcohol abuse condition

It became know that the doctor involved in the incident was sent to a rehabilitation facility in February 2005 by his employer due to disruptive conduct resulting from alcohol abuse, and referred to the Kentucky Physicians Health Foundation ("the Foundation") for evaluation.

Control condition: No information

United Airlines has been criticized for the incident, and is conducting an investigation. The airline promised to release the report to the public upon completion of the investigation. The doctor is now undergoing treatment in a Chicago hospital for his injuries.

Manipulation checks:

Journalistic quality: MC_Article_1, MC_Article_2, MC_Article_3, MC_Article_4, MC_Article_5

How do you find the quality of the article? In my opinion the article … is objective / reports relevant facts and arguments / considers different opinions / does not insult or discriminate / is comprehensible.

(1 = strongly disagree to 7 = strongly agree)

Fairness of victim's depiction: MC_PercVictim_1, MC_PercVictim_2, MC_PercVictim_3

How was the person that was dragged off the plane depicted in the article? In my opinion the person dragged off the plane was depicted … 1 negatively – 7 positively / 1 unfavourable – 7 favourable / 1 unfairly – 7 fairly.

Relevance of the information on the victim: MC_PercRelevance_1, MC_PercRelevance_2, MC_PercRelevance_3

In my opinion the information provided about the person is 1 irrelevant – 7 relevant / 1 not valuable – 7 valuable / 1 not insightful – 7 insightful.

Dependent variables:

Blame attribution: AttrBlame_1, AttrBlame_2, AttrBlame_3

Please answer the following statements regarding who is to blame for the injuries the passenger sustained when being dragged off the plane.

I think, the injuries the passenger sustained reflects an aspect of the … 1 Airline's behaviour – 7 Passenger's behaviour; I think, the injuries the passenger sustained was caused by something about the … 1 Airline – 7 Passenger; I think, the injuries the passenger sustained occurred because of something the … 1 Airline did – 7 Passenger did

Airline reputation: CorporateRep_1, CorporateRep_2, CorporateRep_3, CorporateRep_4, CorporateRep_5, CorporateRep_6, CorporateRep_7, CorporateRep_8, CorporateRep_9, CorporateRep_10

How do you rate United Airlines on the following attributes? In my opinion United Airlines is … 1 unfavourable – 7 favourable / 1 unappealing – 7 appealing / 1 unpleasant – 7 pleasant / 1 unlikable – 7 likable / 1 undependable – 7 dependable / 1 incompetent – 7 competent / 1 of low integrity – 7 of high integrity / 1 unresponsive to customers – 7 responsive to customers / 1 not trustworthy – 7 trustworthy.

Newspaper reputation: Rep_Newspaper_1, Rep_Newspaper_2, Rep_Newspaper_3, Rep_Newspaper_4, Rep_Newspaper_5, Rep_Newspaper_6, Rep_Newspaper_7, Rep_Newspaper_8, Rep_Newspaper_9, Rep_Newspaper_10

How do you rate the newspaper Chicago Herald that published the article? In my opinion the Chicago Herald is … 1 unfavourable – 7 favourable / 1 unappealing – 7 appealing / 1 unpleasant – 7 pleasant / 1 unlikable – 7 likable / 1 undependable – 7 dependable / 1 incompetent – 7 competent / 1 of low integrity – 7 of high integrity / 1 unresponsive to customers – 7 responsive to customers / 1 not trustworthy – 7 trustworthy.

Empathy with the victim: EmpathyVictim_1, EmpathyVictim_2, EmpathyVictim_3

How do you feel about the passenger who was dragged off the plane? I try to imagine what he has gone through; I can empathize with what he has experienced; I find myself moved by his experience.

(1 = strongly disagree to 7 = strongly agree)

Victim reputation: Rep_Victim_1, Rep_Victim_2, Rep_Victim_3, Rep_Victim_4

How do you rate the personality of the passenger that was dragged off the plane? To me he appears … 1 unlikable – 7 likable / 1 unfriendly – 7 friendly / 1 incompetent – 7 competent / 1 immoral – 7 moral.

Sociodemographics:

Finally, please answer some general questions about yourself.

Age What is your age (in years)? Please insert numeric numbers. _____open ended_____

Gender What is your gender? 1 male, 2 female, 3 other

Education What is the highest degree or level of education you have completed?

1 Never attended school, 2 Primary Education, 3 Secondary Education (GCSE/O-Levels), 4 Post-Secondary Education (College, A-Levels, NVQ3 or below, or similar), 5 Vocational Qualification (Diploma, Certificate, BTEC, NVQ 4 and above, or similar), 6 Undergraduate Degree (BA, BSc etc.), 7 Post-graduate Degree (MA, MSc etc.), 8 Doctorate (PhD)

Thank you very much for participating in this survey!

Debriefing:

At the beginning of the survey you were informed that the study was on the perception of media coverage on business incidents. More specifically, the study was on how the information about the victim of the incident (in this case the doctor that was dragged of the plane) affects the perception of the company (the airline), the victim of the incident and the newspaper that published the article. The incident described in the article was modelled after a real case that happened in 2017, when United Airlines dragged a passenger off one of its airplanes. Yet, the article you read was construed by the researchers for the purpose of this study and did not appear like this in the newspaper.

To conclude, is there anything else you would like to say? _____open ended_____

When you click on the blue button with the arrow, the study is finished and you will be redirected.